Instructions in a text file, running as the user

No code executes. The exposure is what the instructions tell the model to read, and whether anyone read the instructions first.

What a skill actually is

- A plain-text Markdown file in the user's own OneDrive, at /Documents/Cowork/skills/.
- It contains instructions, not code. Nothing is executed.
- It runs as the user who invoked it and sees only what that user can see.
- It cannot reach local files, cannot read encrypted files, and cannot delete anything in OneDrive or SharePoint.

Where the risk actually is

- Microsoft does not validate custom skills created by users. A skill is instructions to the AI.
- Approval can be skipped: a user may approve and skip similar prompts for the rest of a session, scoped to a recipient, a domain, or always.
- Scheduled and event-driven tasks run with nobody watching, though they default to draft-and-approve.
- The only durable control is reading the file. Every one here is plain text.

6 of these 23 skills read personal or HR data.
expense reconciliation, internal expert finder, interview loop coordinator, onboarding buddy, one to one prep, subscription hunter. Before anyone runs one of these against other people's data, clear it with HR, your works council and privacy. Sensitivity labels carry through to what Cowork produces, and the output lands in the user's own OneDrive.

What this catalog commits to

- Every skill reads and prepares, then stops. Sending, posting and deleting are not in any skill's instructions.
- Every output line cites the mail, file or meeting it came from. An unsourced line is a defect.
- No skill advises on safety authorisation: permit to work, lock-out tag-out, confined space, JSA, incident classification, inspection sign-off.
- Nothing is obfuscated, minified or compiled. MIT license, read it all.

Questions worth asking before approval

- Which mailbox, which site, which calendar does this read? It is written in the skill's Inputs section.
- What happens on a quiet period? Every skill here states its silent case.
- Who sees the output? The creating user only, unless they approve otherwise.
- What is in the audit log? Automated task activity is recorded alongside other Cowork activity.

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